QP Code: 25901310

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCHIS202 - UNDERSTANDING THE MODERN WORLD

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap) - Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. What is meant by the Thermidorian Reaction - [K] / [CO1, CO5] - The Thermidorian Reaction (July 1794) was the counter-revolutionary revolt within the French National Convention that overthrew and executed Maximilien Robespierre, ending the Reign of Terror. It marked a conservative turn in the French Revolution, leading to the dismantling of Jacobin policies and the establishment of the Directory in 1795.

2. Recall the Quadruple Alliance - [K] / [CO1, CO5] - The Quadruple Alliance (1815) was a coalition formed by Britain, Austria, Prussia, and Russia following Napoleon's defeat, aimed at maintaining the balance of power established by the Congress of Vienna. It served as a collective security mechanism to suppress revolutionary movements and prevent French aggression in Europe.

3. Recall the significance of the 'Kingdom of Rome' - [U] / [CO1, CO2] - The Kingdom of Rome refers to the title given to Napoleon Bonaparte's son, Napoleon II, born in 1811, symbolizing Napoleon's ambition to establish a hereditary imperial dynasty stretching across Europe. Its significance lies in Napoleon's intention to legitimize his empire and secure a lasting Bonapartist succession, though the kingdom never materialized as a real political entity after his fall.

4. What is meant by the Balkan Wars? - [K] / [CO1, CO4] - The Balkan Wars (1912–1913) were two successive conflicts in which the Balkan League (Bulgaria, Serbia, Greece, and Montenegro) first defeated the Ottoman Empire to gain territorial independence, and then fought among themselves over the division of those territories. These wars significantly weakened the Ottoman presence in Europe and heightened nationalist tensions that directly contributed to the outbreak of World War I.

5. Pearl Harbour Attack. - [K] / [CO1] - The Pearl Harbour Attack on December 7, 1941, was a surprise military strike by the Imperial Japanese Navy Air Service against the United States naval base at Pearl Harbour, Hawaii, killing over 2,400 Americans and destroying numerous battleships and aircraft. This attack directly prompted the United States to formally enter World War II by declaring war on Japan the following day.

6. Who were the 'Big Four' in the Paris Peace Conference? [K] / [CO1, CO4] - The 'Big Four' at the Paris Peace Conference (1919) USA, France, Britain and Italy. These four powers dominated the negotiations that shaped the post-WWI world order, most notably producing the Treaty of Versailles.

7. What is meant by neoliberalism? - [K] / [CO3, CO4] - Neoliberalism is an economic and political ideology that advocates for free-market capitalism, deregulation, privatization, reduction of government spending, and the liberalization of trade and investment. It rose to global prominence in the 1970s–80s, particularly associated with the policies of Margaret Thatcher in the UK and Ronald Reagan in the USA.

8. What is meant by Foreign Direct Investment? - [K] / [CO3, CO4] - Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) refers to an investment made by a company or individual in one country into business interests in another country, typically involving establishing business operations or acquiring business assets such as ownership or controlling interest in a foreign company. FDI is a key feature of economic globalization and plays a significant role in the development of host economies by transferring capital, technology, and expertise.

9. Who was Jomo Kenyatta? - [K] / [CO1, CO2, CO4] - Jomo Kenyatta was a Kenyan nationalist leader who led Kenya's struggle for independence from British colonial rule and became the country's first Prime Minister and subsequently its first President. He is regarded as the founding father of modern Kenya and a prominent figure in African anti-colonial movements.

10. What is meant by Cold War? - [K] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4] - The Cold War was a prolonged period of geopolitical tension (1947–1991) between the United States and its Western allies on one side and the Soviet Union and its Eastern bloc on the other, characterized by ideological rivalry between capitalism and communism without direct large-scale military conflict between the two superpowers. It manifested through proxy wars, nuclear arms races, space competition, and political interventions across Asia, Africa, Latin America, and Europe

11. What is meant by Ku Klux Clan? - [K] / [CO1, CO2] - The Ku Klux Klan is a white supremacist, far-right extremist organization founded in the United States in 1865 following the Civil War, notorious for using terror, violence, and intimidation against African Americans, Jews, immigrants, and other minority groups. The Klan experienced multiple waves of resurgence and remains a symbol of racial hatred and domestic terrorism in American history.

12. What is meant by Gulf of Tonkin incident? - [K] / [CO1, CO2, CO4] - The Gulf of Tonkin Incident (August 1964) refers to two alleged confrontations between North Vietnamese naval forces and US destroyers in the Gulf of Tonkin, which the Johnson administration used to justify escalating US military involvement in Vietnam. The incident dramatically deepening US engagement in the Vietnam War.

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay Questions Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

13. Examine the French and English imperialism in Asia and Africa.- [U] / [CO1, CO2] - France established a major presence in North Africa by capturing Algiers in 1830 and Tunisia in 1881, while further extending control over Morocco, Ivory Coast, Dahomey, Gabon, and Eastern Sudan, consolidating a vast African empire through military force and diplomatic negotiations. Britain, driven by strategic and economic interests, bombarded Alexandria in 1882 to seize Egypt and control the Suez Canal, and expanded further into Nigeria, Kenya, Buganda, Tanganyika, Rhodesia, and South Africa, using superior military technology and railroad construction to consolidate its dominance. The West African Conference of Berlin (1884), attended by fifteen nations, formalized the European scramble for Africa by establishing ground rules for colonial acquisition, with Britain and France emerging as the dominant powers dividing territories such as Togoland, Cameroon, and Sudan between themselves. Following World War I, the mandate system further reinforced Anglo-French imperial supremacy, with France receiving Syria, Lebanon, and portions of Togoland and Cameroon, while Britain gained Iraq, Palestine, Transjordan, and additional African territories, cementing their combined imperial dominance across Asia and Africa.

14. Observe the concept of imperialism discussed in the writings of Bukharin. - [U] / [CO1, CO3] Bukharin stated that 'Imperialism as the reproduction of capitalist competition on a large scale'. His argument moves from imperialism as a policy and as an ideology, to imperialism as a characteristic of the world economy at a particular stage of development. Imperialist annexation is only a case of the general capitalist tendency towards centralization of capital, a case of its centralization at that maximum scale which corresponds to the competition of state capitalist trusts.

15. Critically analyse the working of the economic policy of War Communism in Soviet Russia. - [An] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO5] – Economic policy prevailed in between 1917 and 1921 evolved out of the desperate measures taken to supply the battlefront with needed materials and manpower. One feature of War Communism was the nationalization of land, banks, foreign trade, and heavy industry. Another was the forcible requisitioning of surplus agricultural produce needed to feed the soldiers and the city dwellers. The original plan was to compensate the peasants with manufactured goods, but this proved impossible because almost all factories were producing for the front. Industrial and agricultural production went down.

16. Examine the antisemitic ideological propagation in the Nazi Germany.- [U] / [CO1, CO2] – The Nuremberg Laws stripped Jews of their citizenship, reducing them to second-class status based on "impure blood" defined by their grandparents' religion, while "Racial Science" was introduced into school curricula to institutionalize anti-Semitism across German society. In November 1938, state-coordinated attacks destroyed 267 synagogues, killed at least 91 Jews, and sent thousands to concentration camps in what was falsely presented as spontaneous public violence, marking a dramatic escalation of persecution. Nazi policy progressively shifted from expulsion to systematic extermination, with killing squads murdering entire Jewish communities, gas chambers established in dedicated death camps like Auschwitz, and over 700,000 Jews killed at Treblinka alone within five months. The Holocaust culminated in the murder of between 4 to 6 million European Jews

17. Observe the celebration of hyper nationalism and aggressive masculinity in fascist narratives.[An] / [CO1, CO2] - Fascism asked to take pride in common descent from single nation. Always maintained a thought that other is getting ready for a plot, probably an international one. But the plot must come from inside too for a fascist, as per the fascist understanding the Jews in Germany are engaging in a plot against Germany. Fascism is sexist and masculine. When there is no war the fascist hero turns to sex. A machismo imaginary rested on anti-feminine and homophobic attitude. Since even sex is a difficult game to play, the Ur Fascist hero tends to play with weapons – doing so becomes an ersatz phallic exercise, just think from bullets to missiles weapons appeared in the phallic shape.

18. Discuss the origin of the Great Depression of 1930s in USA. [U] / [CO3] - The fundamental cause of the Great Depression was a sharp decline in consumer spending and demand, which led to reduced production, while the American economic collapse was further transmitted to the rest of the world through the gold standard. The war time benefits like exporting of both grains and guns to Europe got arrested following the peace settlements. Stock prices had risen fourfold between 1921 and 1929 to unjustifiable levels, and when minor events triggered gradual price declines in October 1929, investor confidence collapsed, leading to the infamous "Black Thursday" panic on October 24, 1929, when a record 12.9 million shares were traded in a single day. The subsequent Great Crash saw US stock prices decline by 33 percent between September and November 1929, dramatically reducing American aggregate demand and triggering a cycle of liquidation that devastated the broader economy. Banking panics compounded the crisis as depositors simultaneously withdrew savings, forcing banks to hastily liquidate loans, causing even solvent banks to fail, ultimately culminating in the national bank holiday declared by President Franklin D. Roosevelt on March 6, 1933.

19. Analyse the significant characteristics of a dependent economy. - [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4] - Underdeveloped countries experience unsatisfactory economic growth as profits extracted by core countries are repatriated rather than reinvested locally, while their export industries remain heavily dependent on imported inputs, creating a cycle of structural dependency. The income, employment, and growth of underdeveloped economies are dictated not by local market conditions but by international market prices, external demand fluctuations, and the investment decisions of transnational corporations. Economic stability in underdeveloped nations is further conditioned by volatile import prices, economic fluctuations abroad, shifting global tastes and fashions, and the emergence of technologically created substitutes that undermine their export competitiveness. Foreign capital, foreign technology, and foreign management dominate as the principal economic actors, leaving underdeveloped economies with little autonomous control over their own development trajectory.

20. Examine the relevance of the UN organ Trusteeship Council in contemporary times. [E] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4] - The Trusteeship Council was established in 1945 as one of the six principal organs of the United Nations, with the primary mandate of supervising the administration of trust territories and guiding them toward self-governance and independence. The Council successfully fulfilled its original mandate when Palau, the last remaining trust territory, achieved independence in 1994, after which the Council formally suspended its operations on November 1, 1994, meeting only on an extraordinary basis when needed. In contemporary times, the Trusteeship Council is widely regarded as largely redundant and obsolete in its original form, as there are no remaining trust territories under its supervision, prompting ongoing debates within the UN regarding its reformation or complete abolition.

However, some scholars and UN reformers argue for its reinvention as a body overseeing global commons such as the environment, deep seabed resources, and outer space, suggesting a potential contemporary relevance if restructured to address modern challenges of global governance.

21. Discuss the nature of the student movement in France in 1968. [U] / [CO1, CO2, CO4] - The French student movement of 1968, known as "Mai 68," originated at the University of Nanterre and spread to the Sorbonne in Paris, where students protested against authoritarian university administration, outdated educational structures, and the conservative social values of Gaullist France, drawing heavily from Marxist, anarchist, and existentialist ideologies to challenge capitalism and American imperialism. The student uprising rapidly transcended academic grievances to catalyze a massive general strike involving nearly ten million French workers, paralyzing the French economy and transforming a campus revolt into the largest general strike in French history, bringing the country to the brink of revolution. Though de Gaulle's government survived by calling snap elections and winning a landslide victory, Mai 68 left a profound cultural legacy, fundamentally reshaping French society by accelerating social liberalization, feminist movements, workers' rights, and the democratization of education in the decades that followed.

22. Discuss the Chinese nationalist revolution under Sun Yat-sen. [U] / [CO1, CO2, CO5] - Sun Yat-sen, widely regarded as the father of modern China, founded the Tongmenghui revolutionary alliance in 1905 and developed his ideological framework of the "Three Principles of the People" — nationalism, democracy, and people's livelihood — as the philosophical foundation for overthrowing the declining Qing dynasty and ending centuries of imperial rule. The successful Xinhai Revolution of 1911 abolished the Qing dynasty and established the Republic of China, with Sun Yat-sen briefly serving as its first provisional president before being forced to yield power to the militarist Yuan Shikai, exposing the fragility of the new republican order against entrenched warlord power. Sun Yat-sen subsequently reorganized his nationalist movement into the Kuomintang (KMT) party in 1912, and with Soviet assistance restructured it along Leninist lines in 1923, forging the First United Front with the Chinese Communist Party to pursue national unification, a legacy that continued to shape Chinese political development long after his death in 1925.

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay Questions, Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

23. Illustrate the political process of the unification of German states to a nation. [U] / [CO1, CO2] - Modern German nationalism emerged in the late 18th century, stimulated by the French Revolution and the destruction of the Holy Roman Empire by Napoleonic armies, with German Romantics and intellectuals developing an ethnic and linguistic definition of nationalism based on the concept of the "cultural nation" (Kulturnation), while the German Confederation (Bund) of 1815 reduced hundreds of fragmented sovereign states to thirty-eight, serving as the framework for nationalist aspirations. The Frankfurt Parliament of 1848 briefly indicated the possibility of a democratic and united Germany, but the suppression of the democratic movement and the defeat of liberals shifted the character of German unification from a liberal

democratic process to one shaped by conservative Prussian forces and the dynastic rivalry between Prussia and Austria, culminating in the Austro-Prussian War of 1866 which excluded Austria from German affairs. Prussian Chancellor Otto von Bismarck's policy of "blood and iron" decisively achieved unification through the defeat of France in 1871, compelling France to relinquish Alsace as war indemnity, after which Wilhelm was proclaimed German Emperor in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles on January 18, 1871, formally uniting 25 German states under Prussian leadership. Unlike France and Britain, the German nation state was not founded on liberal democratic principles, as the German bourgeoisie was too weak to challenge the conservative Junker landlords, leading instead to a "silent bourgeois revolution" that left German political life significantly undemocratized despite the establishment of a national parliament, the Reichstag.

24. Examine the socio-economic scenario of Russia before the revolution of 1917. [An] / [CO1, CO2, CO3,CO5] - Tsarist Russia was characterized by extreme social backwardness, with about 70% of the population illiterate, no adequate public health or medical relief system, widespread hunger among the majority, and a rigid social structure where a rich landed elite exploited the poor, while the Russian Orthodox Church provided ideological legitimacy to the oppressive order and a corrupt bureaucracy showed no sympathy toward common people. The peasantry, forming the vast majority of the population, experienced severe economic distress that triggered major uprisings in Ukraine, the Volga areas, and Georgia in 1902, with over 3,000 peasant disturbances recorded by early 1905, leading to the formation of the All-Russian Peasants' Union which demanded abolition of private property in land and the convening of a constituent assembly. Industrial workers, though numbering only around 2 million, faced brutal exploitation working 12 to 14 hours daily for low wages with no medical relief, weekly holidays, or right to organize, as trade union formation was considered a crime, resulting in mass strikes in 1902 and approximately 550 work stoppages by 1903, while the mutiny of sailors on the battleship Potemkin in June 1905 reflected the spread of anger and demoralization even into the armed forces. Politically, the Tsarist autocracy concentrated all authority in the hands of the ruler while dismissing the representative Duma, alienating educated liberal Russians who increasingly supported the Union of Liberation movement, and suppressing growing nationalist opposition movements among minority peoples in the Baltic provinces, Ukraine, Poland, and Georgia, creating conditions of widespread revolutionary discontent across all sections of Russian society.

25. Critically analyse dynamics occurred in the global political economy under the influence of Keynesian economics. [An] / [CO3] - Keynesian economics emerged as a direct response to the catastrophic failures of laissez-faire capitalism exposed by the Great Depression of the 1930s, with John Maynard Keynes arguing that aggregate demand was the primary driver of economic growth and that governments must intervene through deficit spending, public works programmes, and fiscal stimulus to restore employment, most notably demonstrated by Roosevelt's New Deal which deployed massive state investment to pull America out of depression. The Keynesian framework fundamentally transformed the relationship between the state and the market by legitimising active government intervention, giving rise to the welfare state across Western Europe and North America, where governments assumed responsibility for social security, universal healthcare, public education, and unemployment insurance, significantly reducing inequality and social unrest in the post-war decades. The post-war economic boom of 1945–1973, often referred to as the "Golden Age of Capitalism,"

represented the triumphant application of Keynesian principles, as Western governments maintained full employment policies, regulated financial markets, and coordinated international economic stability through the Bretton Woods system, producing unprecedented levels of sustained growth, rising wages, and expanding middle classes across the industrialised world. However, the stagflation crisis of the 1970s exposed the limitations of Keynesian demand management, triggering a neoliberal counter-revolution led by Thatcher and Reagan that dismantled welfare provisions and deregulated markets, though the 2008 global financial crisis dramatically renewed interest in state intervention, reaffirming the enduring relevance of Keynesian economics in stabilising market economies.

26. Discuss the role of Mao Zedong in the formation of the revolutionary China. [E] / [CO1, CO2, CO5] - Mao Zedong emerged as a founding member of the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) in 1921 and developed a distinctive form of Marxism adapted to Chinese conditions, arguing that the peasantry rather than the urban proletariat would serve as the primary revolutionary force, a theoretical innovation that fundamentally distinguished Chinese communism from its Soviet counterpart. Following the betrayal of the First United Front by Chiang Kai-shek's Kuomintang in 1927, Mao led the famous Long March of 1934–1935, a gruelling 6,000-mile strategic retreat that established his undisputed leadership of the CCP and transformed the communist movement into a disciplined revolutionary force rooted among the rural peasant masses. Mao successfully led the CCP through the Second United Front against Japanese occupation during World War II and the subsequent civil war against the Kuomintang, culminating in the historic proclamation of the People's Republic of China on 1st October 1949, establishing a communist state and ending a century of foreign humiliation and internal fragmentation. As the paramount leader of the new republic, Mao pursued radical programmes of land redistribution, nationalisation, and mass mobilisation through campaigns such as the Great Leap Forward and the Cultural Revolution, which whilst causing considerable devastation, fundamentally reshaped Chinese society by dismantling feudal structures and laying the ideological foundations of modern revolutionary China.

[10x2 = 20]